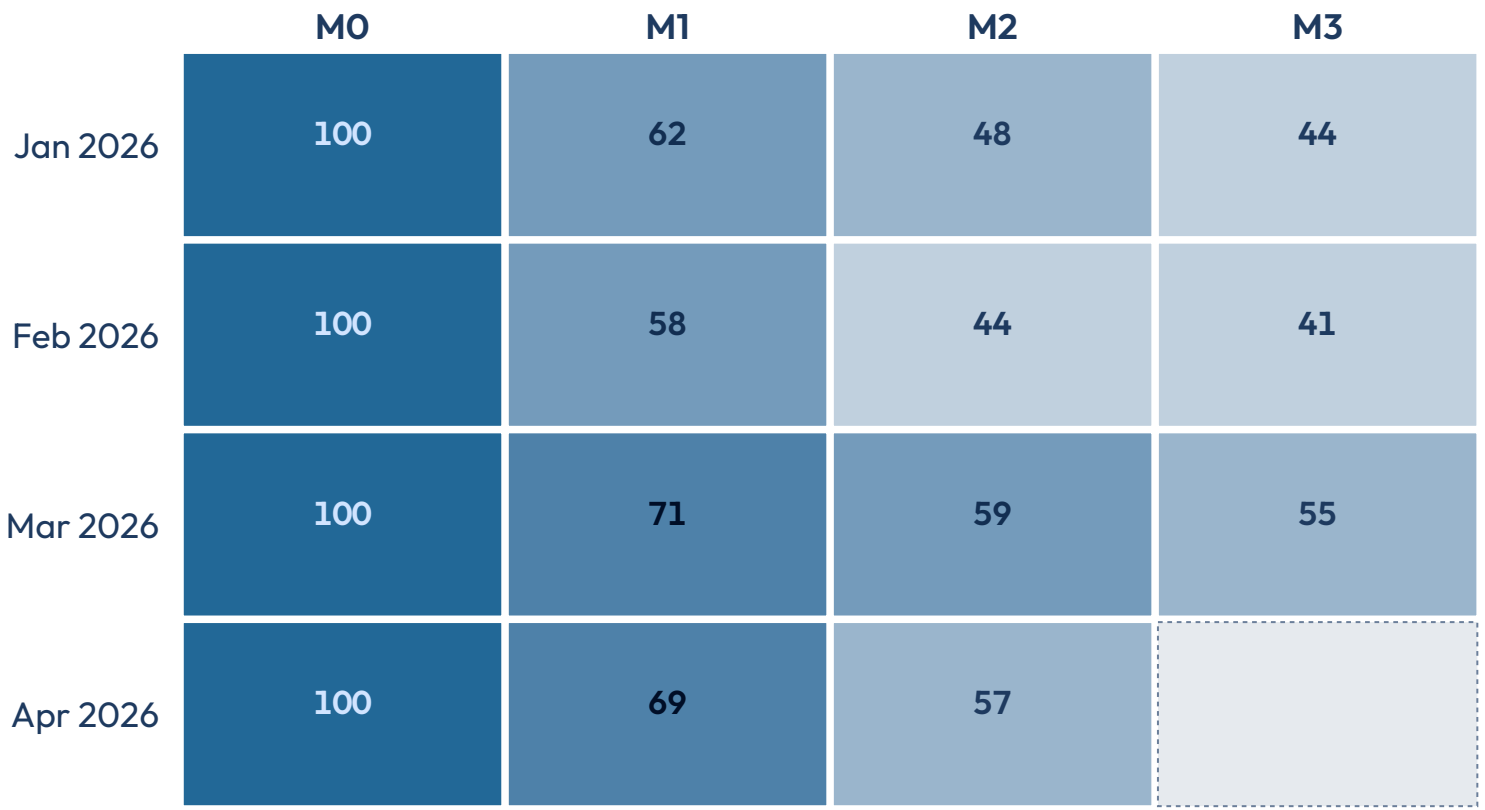
LABEL SETS · HEATMAP · THE KEY A RAMP WAS MISSING

Name the bands, or let the chart do it.

A heatmap's five tones carry meaning no reader can recover from the tones alone. A **label set** names them — derived from the data by default, overridden where the words matter.

RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

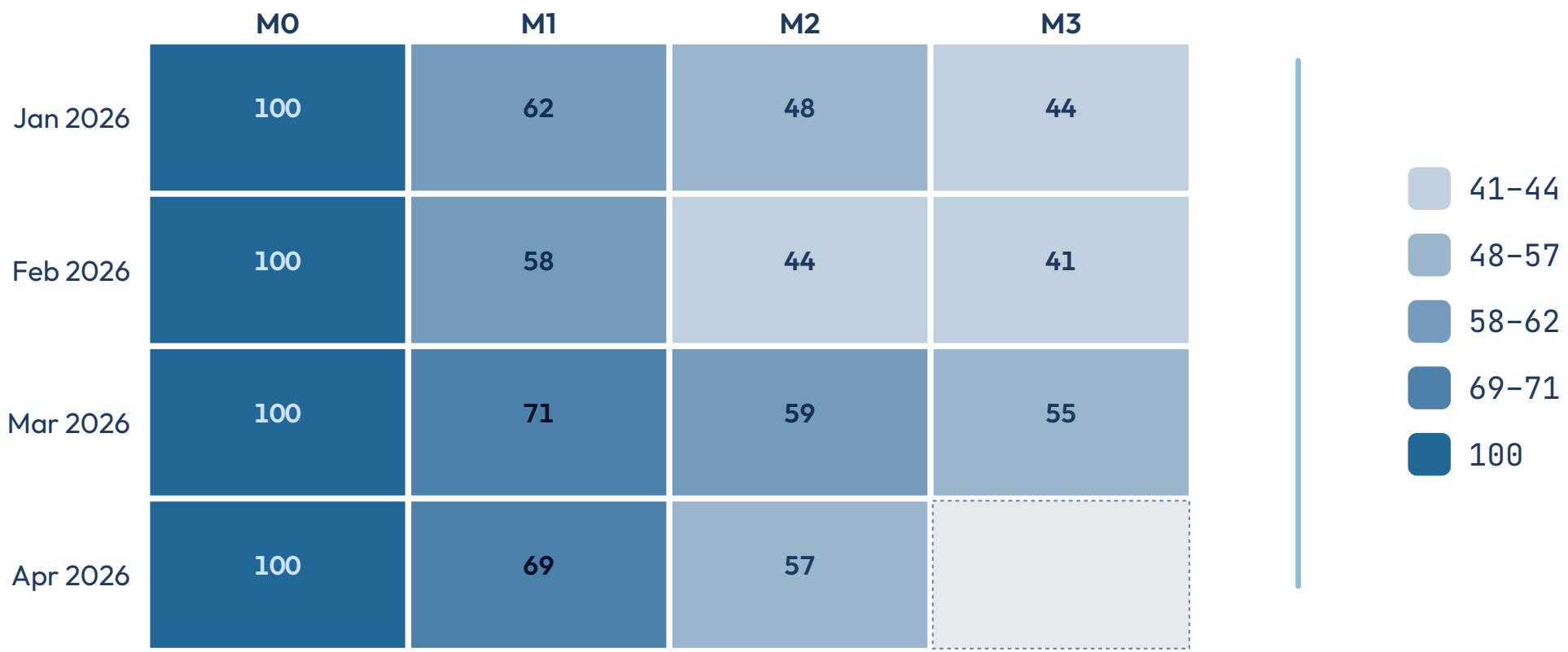
Without a key, the tones are unexplained.



No key · the default, unchanged

RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

The chart can name its own bands.

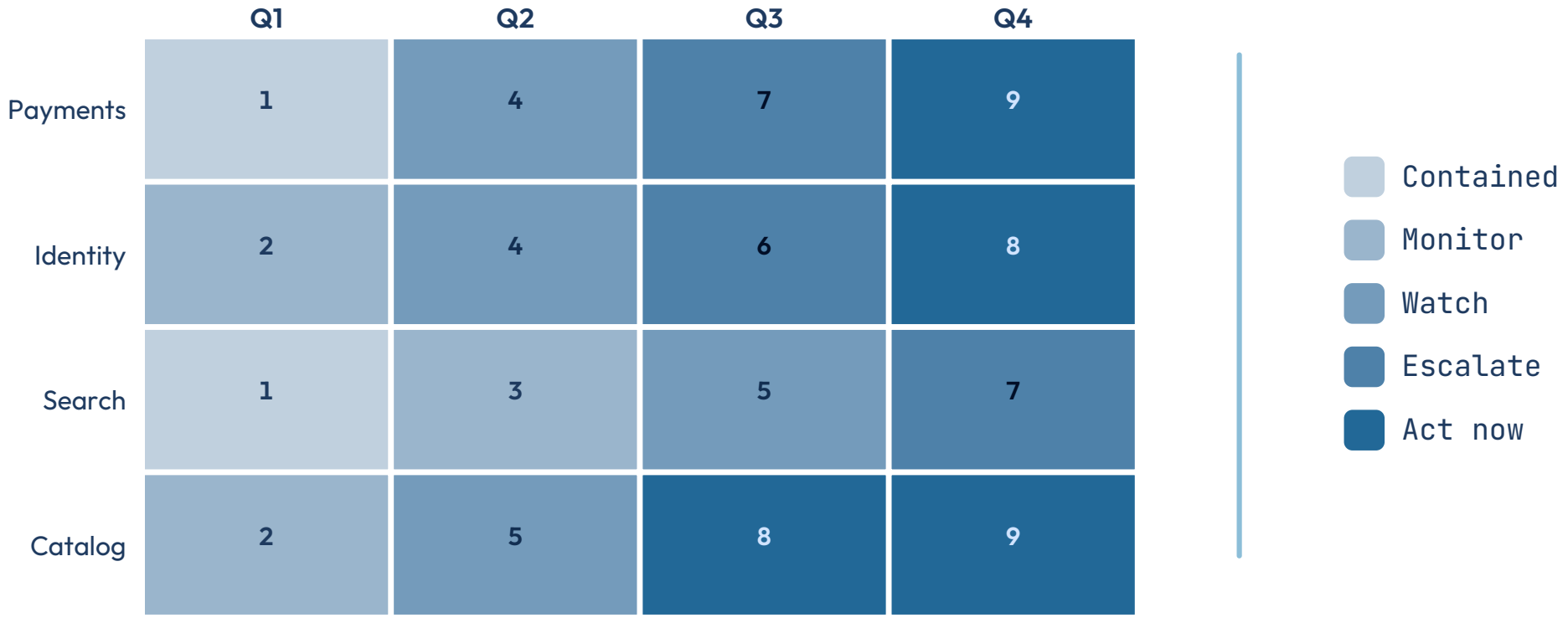


Derived · the chart names its own bands

RISK · BY SYSTEM AND QUARTER

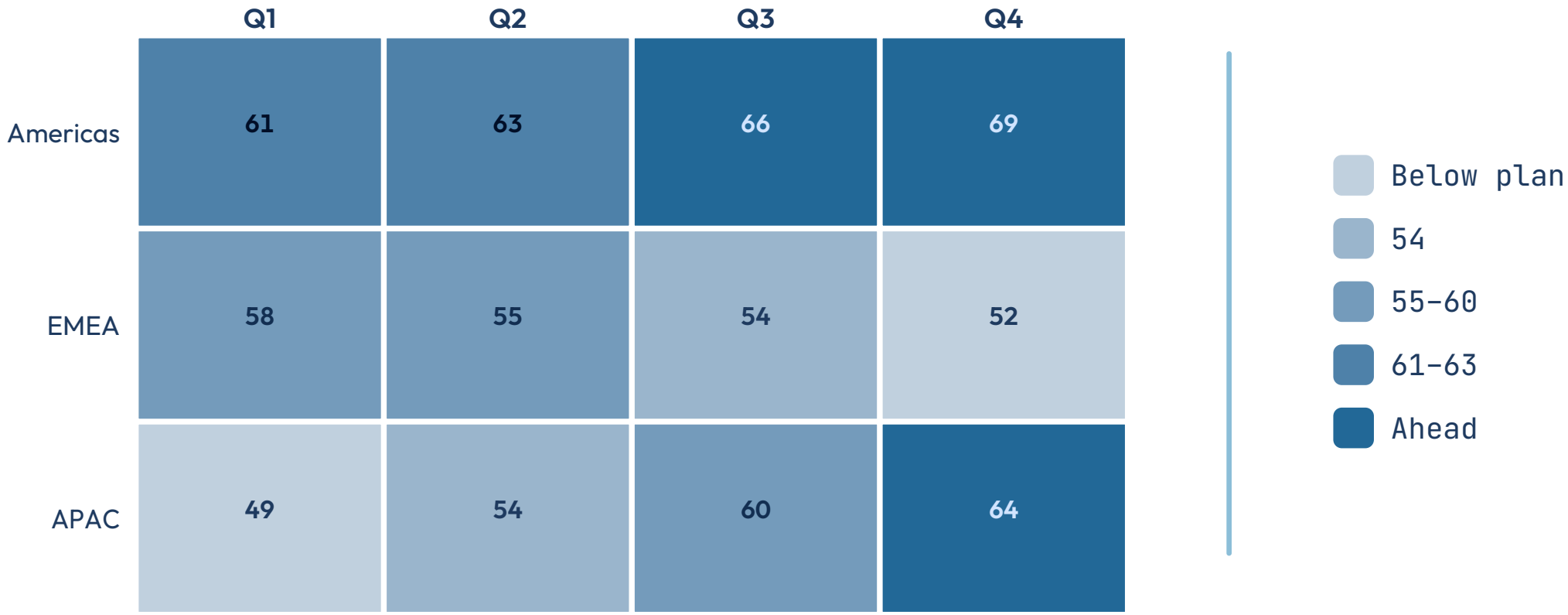
Where a number means nothing, a word means everything.

The key binds to the ramp STEP, one through five — not to a value in the table.



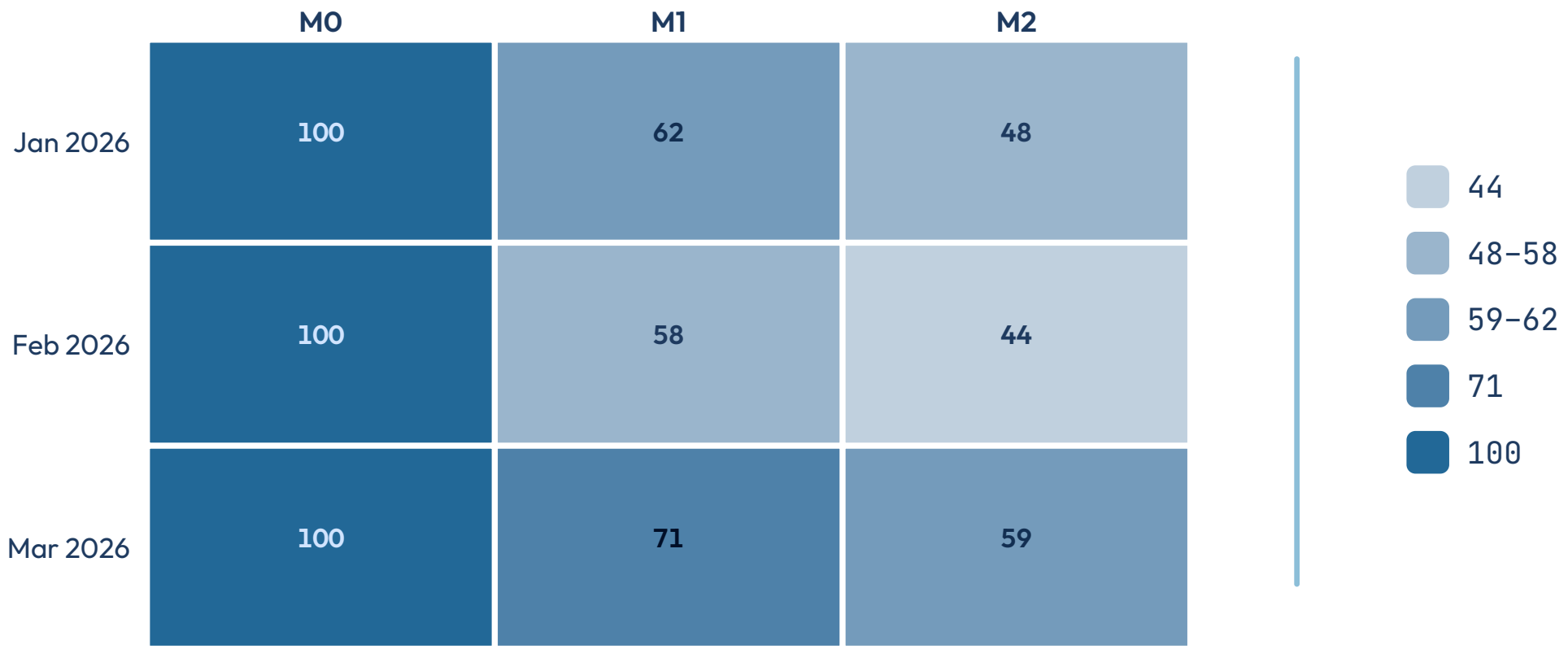
MARGIN · BY REGION

Name only the bands that carry a decision.



RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

A cell can carry its own explanation.



One entry, three ways to write it.

- **Derived.**
  - Add `scale` and the chart names each band by the values it covers.
- **Inline.**
  - `` `[{1, Cold}, {3, Warm}, {5, Hot}]` `` above the table. Name some, keep the rest.
- **Per cell.**
  - `` `note=prose` `` inside a cell. Hover on screen, speaker note in print.